Your Name

BIOL 336 XXX

Dec 3rd

Post lecture "Quiz": Mutualisms

The mutualism between yucca plants (Yucca spp.) and yucca moths (Tegeticula spp.) is maintained in part by host sanctions against cheating moths. Yucca flowers selectively abort when moths lay too many eggs, reducing the fitness of over-exploiting moths and favouring lineages that pollinate while keeping egg loads low. Empirical support comes from Pellmyr & Huth (1994), who demonstrated that flowers with excessive oviposition were significantly more likely to be aborted.

Citation:

Pellmyr, O. & Huth, C.J. (1994). *Evolutionary stability of mutualism between yuccas and yucca moths*. Nature, 372, 257–260.